Ultimate Weather

How to use your 4.3 inch desk

This desk shows the weather for the town you choose, plus lightning strikes within 25 miles, earthquakes, the clock, the night sky, rocket launches, and the space station. There is no app and no account. Keep it plugged in, and give it your home Wi-Fi.

This is the Freenove 4.3 inch screen. The pages are the same as the 7 inch desk. The picture is drawn at that size and then fitted onto this smaller glass. Plug the USB cable into the Type-C port that shows up as CH340.

First time

1. Plug in the power cable. The screen comes on.

2. Tap WIFI along the bottom. Tap SCAN and pick your network, or type the name. Type the password on the keyboard. ABC switches to capital letters. !# switches to numbers and symbols. Tap SAVE.

If it joins, you return to the home screen. If it says no join, check the name and the password and tap SAVE again. If your home has two network names and one ends in 5G, use the other name.

3. Tap PLACE. Type a US city or ZIP and tap SEARCH. Tap the matching place. The clock and the weather follow that town. Give it a minute. The numbers fill in as they arrive.

If this desk was already set up as Sky Weather, it keeps that town and that Wi-Fi.

The buttons along the bottom

PLACE changes the town. RADAR opens the pictures from above. RAIN opens the next 12 hours. SKY opens the clock, launches, the night sky, and the space station. WIFI opens the network. SET opens the look, the lamp, the tide choice, the temperature, and updates.

Home screen

The town name is at the upper left. The clock at the upper right shows the hour and the minute for that town. It does not show seconds. It changes once a minute.

The strike box sits between the town and the clock. The big number is how many lightning strikes were reported inside 25 miles during the last 30 minutes. Under STRIKES it shows how many miles away the latest strike was. When none were reported, that line is a dash.

The count refreshes about every 30 seconds.

Strikes come from the Blitzortung community network. Coverage is uneven. A strike can be missed, or placed a few miles from where you heard it. This box is not a detector sitting in the room, and it is not a safety alarm. When you hear thunder, go indoors.

The bar under that is about warnings. On a clear, quiet day it says ALL CLEAR. If the sky is cloudy or wet and nothing is posted, it says NO WARNINGS. If the desk wants you to stay inside, it says STAY IN. If a warning is posted, that line names it and when it ends. Tap the line to read the list. Warnings are for places in the United States.

Four dials fill the middle.

WIND is the speed in miles per hour, with the gust and the day's highest gust. DIRECTION is the compass direction the wind is coming from. Both come from the nearest National Weather Service station for the town you set. TEMP is the temperature, with today's forecast high and low. HUMIDITY is the humidity, with what it feels like.

The desk asks that station about every 30 seconds. The station sends a new wind report about once an hour. The speed, the gust, and the direction stay put until that next report. Asking more often does not create a new measurement.

A one-minute wind from the same stations does exist. The free public copy of it is about a day behind, so it is not the wind outside right now. The live one-minute copy needs an account key this desk does not have. Weather apps that keep changing are usually a forecast, not that station. The forecast can say nearly calm from the east while the station says a real breeze from the northwest. If the station cannot be reached, the desk uses that forecast until the station answers again.

PRESSURE and the rain so far today refresh on that same check, about every 30 seconds. Temperature and humidity refresh about every 5 minutes.

The row under the dials is dew point, UV, air quality, PRESSURE in inches, rain so far today, and TODAY. TODAY is the highest and lowest temperature the desk has seen since midnight. The high is red. The low is blue. The temperature dial still shows the forecast high and low. Those are two different numbers.

Tap the wind dial or the direction dial for wind and air pressure. Tap the temperature dial or the humidity dial for the next 7 days. Tap UV for the clock and the sun path. Tap PRESSURE for wind and air pressure. Tap RAIN in that row for the next 12 hours. Tap TODAY for the next 7 days.

If tides are set to SHOW, a tide row sits under that line, on its own. The three cards sit under it. If tides are set to HIDE, that row is not on the home screen at all, and the three cards sit higher.

QUAKES TODAY is the nearest earthquake within 75 miles. It shows the magnitude, the miles, and the depth. If today's quakes are all farther than that, it says none within 75 mi. Tap it for the full list. FORECAST is the next four days. Each day is a small picture, then the high, then the low. Tap it for all seven. The right card shows the moon, sunrise, sunset, and the rain chance for the next 6 hours. Tap it for the rain page.

The moon line says moon phase, with the percent that is lit, and a small picture of that phase.

The tide row follows TIDE on the setup page. SHOW puts the next high and the next low on the home screen if you are near a coast in the United States. Inland, it says no coast tide. That is normal. If a coast is nearby and the times have not come in yet, it says tide waiting. HIDE leaves tides off the home screen. The desk starts with tides showing.

Quakes

The list is today's quakes, from midnight at your town. It holds sixteen, and the page stops at two. Eight quakes fit on a page. When there are more than eight, PAGE 2 at the bottom opens the rest. PAGE 1 brings you back. If there are eight or fewer, that button stays hidden. Closer ones come first, and quakes from the rest of the world stay on this list too. Each line shows the magnitude, where it was, how far it is, the depth, and how long ago. FELT means the distance is close enough that it might have been noticed. That is an estimate. This desk is not a seismometer and it is not an early warning. A tsunami note shows only when the report carries that flag.

USA opens a picture of the United States, with Alaska and Hawaii set to the side. WORLD opens the world picture. A pink dot is your town. Other dots are today's quakes, from both pages of the list. Tap a dot. The lines under the picture name that quake: the magnitude, the miles, the depth, and the place. Tap a row on the list to open it on the world picture. Earthquake dots are only on these two pictures. The space station page does not show them.

Reports come from the USGS. They cover the world. They refresh about every 5 minutes. The list clears at midnight and fills again with the new day. The home card clears with it. Until a new quake is inside 75 miles, the home card says none today.

Radar

SAT is a picture of the ground from above. CLOUDS is that same picture with the bright clouds laid on it. STORM is that picture with the colored storm picture laid on it. Town names appear on the picture, along with rivers and lakes when they are nearby. The picture is large, so it updates more slowly than the numbers on the home screen.

Rain and the forecast

The RAIN button along the bottom is the next 12 hours, drawn as bars.

The 7 day page lists each day, the sky in a short word, and the high and the low. The high is red. The low is blue. Those highs and lows are the National Weather Service forecast for your town. The words can be sunny, clear, partly, cloudy, rain, snow, fog, or storm.

Sky

Four tiles.

CLOCK is the time, sunrise, sunset, the sky in a word, and the path of the sun. The numbers on the path are how strong the sun is, and the UV. After sunset the sun on that path hides until morning. The clock does not show seconds.

LAUNCH is upcoming rocket launches: the rocket, the place, and the time. That list updates about every 30 minutes.

NIGHT is the night sky. Planets that are up come first, then the moon, then stars and clusters. Tap PAGE 2 when it is shown, to see the rest. PAGE 1 brings you back.

ISS is the space station. You see the world, day and night, the path, and when you can look for it. A pink dot is your town. If it is passing where you can see it, the screen says LOOK and a direction.

Back and home

BACK returns to the page you came from. From either quake picture, BACK returns to the quake list. HOME returns to the main screen.

Set

LOOK is DARK or LIGHT.

LAMP is DIM, MID, or BRIGHT. Bright is full. Dim and mid are softer.

TIDE is SHOW or HIDE. SHOW adds the tide row on the home screen. HIDE leaves tides off the home screen. The choice stays until you change it.

F shows Fahrenheit. C shows Celsius. The choice stays until you change it.

WIFI on this page opens the network page. ABOUT is for updates.

FACTORY RESET clears this desk only: the town, the network, and the choices on this screen. The desk restarts. It does not change anything else in your house, and it does not clear a different desk that shares the same board.

On the Wi-Fi page, SAVE stores the name and password and tries to join. RESET WIFI forgets the network name and password. FACTORY on that page does the same full clear as FACTORY RESET.

Updates

Tap SET, then ABOUT. The page shows the version that is on your desk. CHECK looks at the 4.3 inch GitHub page for this desk. It does not use the 7 inch page.

Tap CHECK FOR UPDATES and leave the desk on Wi-Fi. If nothing newer is waiting, it says so.

If a newer one is ready, it shows that version and asks you to tap INSTALL. Leave the desk plugged in. Do not unplug it while it says it is downloading. It restarts on its own when it is done.

A few things that are normal

Pictures in the shop use a sample town. Your screen shows the town you picked.

The strike count can sit at zero on a quiet day. That is the report, not a broken box. Lightning is asked about every 30 seconds. A zero means no strikes inside 25 miles in the last 30 minutes.

The wind number can sit still for close to an hour. That is the station's report, not a stuck screen.

A quake far away can still appear on the list. The miles tell you it is not local. The home card only names one within 75 miles.

The first time you open the space station, the world picture is already there. The path and the list of passes fill in once the desk is on Wi-Fi.

If the Wi-Fi drops, the desk keeps showing the last numbers it has. Join the network again when you can.